DC254 INTELLIGENCE PRODUCT · PILOT 01 SAMPLE

Kenya Data Centre Opportunity Brief

Kenya capacity and delivery signals

Kenya's next capacity story is concentrated, staged and not yet fully live. The immediate opportunity sits with facilities already operating or under construction in Nairobi and Ruiru; the largest early-stage announcements are watchlist signals, not evidence of demand.

EDITION

Pilot 01 · Q4 2026
Format: 5-page sample of a 4-6 page brief

EVIDENCE CHECKED THROUGH

October 2026 (2026-10)
Dataset 2026-Q3

CLASSIFICATION

Public sample,
selected analysis redacted

GEOGRAPHIC COVERAGE

Kenya (27 verified facilities; 4 East Africa reference records tracked separately and excluded from Kenyan figures)

INTENDED BUYER

Infrastructure vendors, investors, operators, consultants and technology providers assessing where Kenya's data-centre capacity is actually delivering.

REDACTED SAMPLE

Illustrative structure; selected pages and buyer-specific analysis withheld. Redaction removes commercial analysis, never the sources. No black box hides information that was never verified.

THE ONE-PAGE ANSWER

Usable capacity is concentrated, staged and not yet fully live

DC254 tracks **27 verified facilities in Kenya**: **20 operational**, 3 under construction, 1 committed and 3 early stage. The directory separates approximately **42.9 MW of live designed capacity** (built, operational) from approximately **10.5 MW of published in-service IT load**, and from a developer-announced pipeline of roughly 230 MW. The gap between those three numbers is the market's real story: what is sold, what is running, and what is still a slide deck.

27	42.9 MW	10.5 MW	7
Verified facilities in Kenya	Live designed capacity (operational)	Published in-service IT load	Subsea cables in service

What this means

1. **The opportunity is not evenly distributed.** Operating and construction-stage facilities offer the clearest near-term commercial visibility; early-stage megawatts are watchlist signals, not demand.
2. **Staging discipline is the product.** Roughly 272.9 MW is tracked across all stages, but only the operational 42.9 MW is built capacity, and only 10.5 MW is published as live IT load. Treating announced figures as demand is the classic error this brief exists to prevent.
3. **Connectivity is not the bottleneck; evidence is.** 7 systems are live at the Kenyan segment and an eighth (Africa-1) has landed without a ready-for-service date. The scarce input is verified, dated market evidence.

Evidence confidence, as used in this brief

HIGH Facility identity and status where operator and independent evidence agree.

MEDIUM Credible single-source facility or capacity claims; operator-cited specifications awaiting independent milestones.

LOW Fragmentary or not independently corroborated claims. Flagged, never silently promoted.

> Full dataset: every figure above is generated from the same versioned dataset that powers the public directory and tracker at data-centers-254.vercel.app (verified through 2026-10). The paid brief never quotes numbers the public site does not.

What changed, and two signals in full

SIGNAL	WHAT DC254 SEES	WHY IT MATTERS
Operating base	20 operational facilities tracked	Existing operators and suppliers have the clearest near-term market access
Construction	3 facilities under construction, including iXAfrica NBOX1.2 and Nxtra Tatu City	Identifiable procurement and commissioning windows
Early-stage pipeline	3 projects, including a 100 MW announced AI facility	Large headline figures require milestone evidence before being treated as demand
Connectivity	7 submarine systems live; Africa-1 landed, RFS pending	Mombasa remains the international landing and redundancy point
Policy	CA standalone data-centre licence framework in consultation	Licensing clarity may change operator costs and market visibility

SIG-01

OPERATIONAL

iColo Nairobi Two (NBO2) launched as live capacity in September 2026

PROJECT / ORG	**iColo Nairobi Two (NBO2)** · iColo (Digital Realty)
LOCATION	Karen campus, Nairobi (about 300 m from NBO1)
WHAT CHANGED	Digital Realty's launch announcement of 7 September 2026 confirms NBO2 as operational at 6.4 MW designed capacity, on a campus with 2N power and N+2 cooling; the launch PR also states iColo transitions to the Digital Realty brand in Kenya.
SUPPLIER RELEVANCE	A newly operational facility moves the supplier conversation from project bidding to operations and phase two: ongoing maintenance, monitoring, spares, and any expansion fit-out. Vendors of power distribution, cooling service and monitoring should treat NBO2 as a live account, not a prospect.
CONFIDENCE	**Medium** · Launch is operator-announced and independently reported; the 6.4 MW figure is from the launch PR while an earlier 6.5 MW IT-load figure from 2024 is recorded as a pre-launch discrepancy.
NEXT QUESTION	Verify whether a second phase or hall expansion is scheduled, and who holds the maintenance contracts for the live plant.
LAST CHECKED	2026-10
EVIDENCE	1. Digital Realty, NBO2 launch press release (7 Sep 2026; captured 10 Oct 2026) · OPERATOR · https://www.digitalrealty.com/about/newsroom/press-releases/3357028/digital-realty-strengthens-nairobi-as-east-africa-digital-gateway-with-new-data-center 2. Capital FM (via allAfrica), NBO2 launch, 7 Sep 2026 · PRESS · https://allafrica.com/stories/202609080028.html 3. PeeringDB facility record (fetched 8 Sep 2026) · REGISTRY · https://www.peeringdb.com/fac/14166

REDACTED IN PUBLIC SAMPLE

Buyer-specific target fit, contact strategy and commercial prioritisation score for this signal.

EXAMPLE SIGNAL · OPPORTUNITY LENS

A construction-stage signal, read as a vendor

SIG-02

UNDER CONSTRUCTION

iXAfrica NBOX1.2 adds 18 MW of high-density capacity under construction in Nairobi

PROJECT / ORG	**iXAfrica NBOX1.2** · iXAfrica Data Centres
LOCATION	Nairobi (NBOX campus)
WHAT CHANGED	Operator campus specifications (retrieved 22 September 2026) cite NBOX1.2 at 18 MW and 3,744 racks with design targets up to 50 kW per rack for AI workloads, completing a 22.5 MW campus with the operational NBOX1.1 (4.5 MW live).
SUPPLIER RELEVANCE	3,744 racks at up to 50 kW per rack implies liquid or high-density cooling, high-capacity busway and power trains, and structured cabling at rack scale. The construction stage is the window in which those specifications are still being finalised with the developer.
CONFIDENCE	**Medium** · Specifications are operator-cited and consistent with credible trade coverage, but no independent commissioning milestone has been published yet.
NEXT QUESTION	Ask the developer for the hall handover sequence and which phase of NBOX1.2 procurement is still open.
LAST CHECKED	2026-10
EVIDENCE	1. iXAfrica, campus plans and specifications (retrieved 22 Sep 2026) · OPERATOR · https://ixafrica.co.ke/ 2. DataCenterDynamics, iXAfrica coverage · PRESS · https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/search/?q=iXAfrica 3. PeeringDB facility record (fetched 8 Sep 2026) · REGISTRY · https://www.peeringdb.com/fac/13572

Where to focus first

1. **Operating facilities (20 tracked).** The strongest evidence of active technical requirements, maintenance cycles and expansion potential. The newest live capacity is iColo NBO2, launched 7 September 2026.
2. **Construction-stage projects (3 tracked).** Clearer project windows than early-stage announcements, but timing should be confirmed with the developer: Nxtra's reported commissioning date has already slipped once, to July 2027.
3. **Energy and connectivity partners.** Power reliability, cooling efficiency, fibre diversity and interconnection remain recurring needs across every stage of the pipeline.

What not to assume

- Announced capacity is not the same as active customer demand.
- Kenya's renewable-generation share does not prove site-specific power delivery.
- A planned AI project is not evidence of a live procurement programme.
- A cable landing is not the same as ready-for-service traffic.

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The buyer-specific sections of this page in the paid brief: named target ranking for your category, recommended first conversation per account, and the internal prioritisation scores behind them.

What DC254 monitors next, and the sources behind this sample

Watchlist

WATCH ITEM	TRIGGER TO WATCH	CONFIDENCE
iXAfrica NBOX1.2 construction milestones	Hall handover, first commissioning or a published energisation date	MEDIUM
Nxtra Tatu City phase-one commissioning	Confirmed commissioning date replacing the reported July 2027 slip	MEDIUM
Africa-1 ready-for-service	RFS announcement at the Mombasa landing	MEDIUM
CA standalone data-centre licence framework	Final instrument, effective date or operator guidance after the public consultation	MEDIUM
Microsoft-G42 AI data centre	Land, financing, construction or customer evidence	LOW UNTIL CORROBORATED
Operator capacity disclosure	Any operator publishing live IT load or commissioned capacity, which DC254 records immediately	HIGH WHEN DIRECTLY PUBLISHED

Evidence register

SOURCE	LOCATION	USED FOR
Digital Realty, NBO2 launch press release (7 Sep 2026)	https://www.digitalrealty.com/about/newsroom/press-releases/3357028/digital-realty-strengthens-nairobi-as-east-africa-digital-gateway-with-new-data-center	SIG-01
iXAfrica, campus plans and specifications (retrieved 22 Sep 2026)	https://ixafrica.co.ke/	SIG-02
Eng. John K. Tanui (PS ICT), Kenya compute-hub positioning (15 Sep 2026)	https://www.linkedin.com/pulse/positioning-kenya-africas-preferred-data-centre-hub-tanui-cbs-ic3jf	SIG-03
DataCenterDynamics, Nxtra Kenya coverage	https://www.datacenterdynamics.com/en/search/?q=Nxtra+Kenya	SIG-03
Africa-1 consortium site	https://www.africa-1.africa/	SIG-04
Semafor / Business Daily, Microsoft-G42 Kenya coverage	https://www.semafor.com/	SIG-05
PeeringDB facility records (fetched 8 Sep 2026)	https://www.peeringdb.com/	SIG-01, SIG-02

Every entry re-verified 2026-10; per-claim links and confidence grades live in the dataset and the paid brief.

> The strongest near-term opportunity is where evidence and delivery overlap: operating facilities, construction-stage projects and the layers that make them usable.

Get the full brief

Product page and redacted sample: data-centers-254.vercel.app/opportunity-brief · enquiries via the product form or elmaccommunicationslimited@gmail.com

Pilot pricing: single brief US$75-150; three-brief bundle US$250-375; custom buyer lens from US$300; institutional licence quoted. Final scope and price are confirmed with you before any payment.

DC254 does not guarantee contracts, procurement access, project completion or sales outcomes.